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This course defines what students should understand and be able to do by the end of 6th grade. Knowledge acquisition should be the primary purpose of any reading approach as the systematic building of a wide range of knowledge across domains is a prerequisite to higher literacy. At this grade level, students are building their facility with rhetoric, the craft of using language in writing and speaking, using classic literature, essays, and speeches as mentor texts.

The benchmarks in this course are mastery goals that students are expected to attain by the end of the year. To build mastery, students will continue to review and apply earlier grade-level benchmarks and expectations.

# M/J Language Arts 1 (#1001010)

Version: 2024 - And Beyond (current)

## Course Standards

Visit the specific benchmark webpage to find related instructional resources.

- [ELA.6.C.1.2](#): Write personal or fictional narratives using narrative techniques, precise words and phrases, and figurative language.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* See [Writing Types](#) and [Narrative Techniques](#).

*Clarification 2:* Figurative language at this grade level should include any on which students have received instruction in this or previous grades. See Figurative Language Standard.

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.1.3:](#) Write and support a claim using logical reasoning, relevant evidence from sources, elaboration, and a logical organizational structure with varied transitions.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* See [Writing Types](#) and [Elaborative Techniques](#).

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.1.4:](#) Write expository texts to explain and/or analyze information from multiple sources, using a logical organizational structure, relevant elaboration, and varied transitions.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* See [Writing Types](#) and [Elaborative Techniques](#).

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.1.5:](#) Improve writing by planning, revising, and editing, considering feedback from adults and peers.

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.2.1:](#)

Present information orally, in a logical sequence, using nonverbal cues, appropriate volume, clear pronunciation, and appropriate pacing.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Nonverbal cues appropriate to this grade level are posture, tone, expressive delivery, focus on the audience, and facial expression. Clear pronunciation should be interpreted to mean an understanding and application of phonics rules and sight words as well as care taken in delivery. A student's speech impediment should not be considered as impeding clear pronunciation. Appropriate pacing is adhering to the pauses dictated by punctuation and speaking at a rate that best facilitates comprehension by the audience. Too fast a pace will lose listeners and too slow can become monotonous. This element will also help students address the nervousness that may make them speak too fast during presentations.

*Clarification 2:* For further guidance, see the [Secondary Oral Communication Rubric](#).

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.3.1:](#)

Follow the rules of standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling appropriate to grade level.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Skills to be mastered at this grade level are as follows:

- Use verbals including gerunds, infinitives, and participial phrases.
- Use comparative and superlative forms of adjectives.
- Use pronouns correctly with regard to case, number, and person, correcting for vague pronoun reference.

Skills to be implemented but not yet mastered are as follows:

- Appropriately use colons.
- Appropriately use dangling modifiers.
- Appropriately use ellipses.
- Appropriately use hyphens.
- Vary sentence structure.

*Clarification 2:* See [Convention Progression by Grade Level](#) for more information.

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.4.1:](#)

Conduct research to answer a question, drawing on multiple reliable and valid sources and refocusing the inquiry when appropriate.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* While the benchmark does require that students consult multiple sources, there is no requirement that they use every source they consult. Part of the skill in researching is discernment—being able to tell which information is relevant and which sources are trustworthy enough to include.

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.C.5.1](#): Integrate diverse digital media to enhance audience engagement in oral or written tasks.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Multimedia elements may include, but are not limited to, drawings, pictures, artifacts, and audio or digital representation. At this grade level, students are using more than one element. The elements may be of the same type (for example, two pictures or a picture and an audio recording). The elements should relate directly to the task and complement the information being shared, meaning that the multimedia elements should add information to the presentation, not restate or reinforce it. The elements should be smoothly integrated into the presentation.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.C.5.2](#): Use digital tools to produce writing.  
Standard Relation to Course: Major
- [ELA.6.R.1.1](#): Analyze how the interaction between characters contributes to the development of a plot in a literary text.  
Standard Relation to Course: Major
- [ELA.6.R.1.2](#):

Analyze the development of stated or implied theme(s) throughout a literary text.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* For the purposes of this benchmark, theme is not a one- or two-word topic, but a complete thought that communicates the author's message. See Theme in Glossary.

*Clarification 2:* Students should be introduced to the concept of universal themes, although mastery isn't expected until 9th grade. A universal theme is an idea that applies to anyone, anywhere, regardless of cultural differences. Examples include, but are not limited to, an individual's or a community's confrontation with nature; an individual's struggle toward understanding, awareness, and/or spiritual enlightenment; the tension between the ideal and the real; the conflict between human beings and advancements in technology/science; the impact of the past on the present; the inevitability of fate; the struggle for equality; and the loss of innocence.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.1.3](#):

Explain the influence of multiple narrators and/or shifts in point of view in a literary text.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* When referring to the person of the narrator, the term point of view is used. Students focused on perspective in 5th grade, so they should differentiate between point of view and perspective when working on this benchmark.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.1.4:](#) Describe the impact of various poetic forms on meaning and style.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Poetic forms used for this benchmark are sonnet and villanelle.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.2.1:](#) Explain how individual text sections and/or features convey meaning in texts.
- Standard Relation to Course: Major
- [ELA.6.R.2.2:](#) Analyze the central idea(s), implied or explicit, and its development throughout a text.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Various types of support could include an author's use of facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or quotations to develop the central idea(s) in a text.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.2.3:](#) Analyze authors' purpose(s) in multiple accounts of the same event or topic.
- Standard Relation to Course: Major
- [ELA.6.R.2.4:](#) Track the development of an argument, identifying the types of reasoning used.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* For more information on types of reasoning, see [Types of Logical Reasoning](#).

*Clarification 2:* Instruction in types of reasoning will include an introduction to fallacies in reasoning. Fallacies that are related to content, informal fallacies, will be the focus. See [Fallacies in Reasoning \(Informal\)](#).

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.3.1:](#) Explain how figurative language contributes to tone and meaning in text(s).

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Figurative language use that students will analyze are metaphor, simile, alliteration, onomatopoeia, personification, hyperbole, and idiom. Other examples can be used in instruction.

*Clarification 2:* See [Secondary Figurative Language](#).

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.3.2:](#) Paraphrase content from grade-level texts.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Most grade-level texts are appropriate for this benchmark.

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.3.3:](#) Compare and contrast how authors from different time periods address the same or related topics.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Texts for this benchmark should be selected from the following literary periods:

- Colonial and Early National Period (1600–1830) *American Literature*
- Romantic Period (1790–1870)
- Realism and Naturalism Period (1870–1930)
- Modernist Period (1910–1945)
- Contemporary Period (1945–present)

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.R.3.4:](#) Identify rhetorical appeals in a text.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Students will identify the appeals of logos, ethos, and pathos.

*Clarification 2:* See [Rhetorical Appeals](#).

Standard Relation to Course: Major

- [ELA.6.V.1.1:](#) Integrate academic vocabulary appropriate to grade level in speaking and writing.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* To integrate vocabulary, students will apply the vocabulary they have learned to authentic speaking and writing tasks independently. This use should be intentional, beyond responding to a prompt to use a word in a sentence.

*Clarification 2:* Academic vocabulary appropriate to grade level refers to words that are likely to appear across subject areas for the current grade level and beyond, vital to comprehension, critical for academic discussions and writing, and usually require explicit instruction.

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.V.1.2](#): Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine meanings of words and phrases in grade-level content.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* See [Common Greek and Latin Roots](#) 6-8 and [Affixes](#).

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.6.V.1.3](#): Apply knowledge of context clues, figurative language, word relationships, reference materials, and/or background knowledge to determine the connotative and denotative meaning of words and phrases, appropriate to grade level.

**Clarifications:**

*Clarification 1:* Review of words learned in this way is critical to building background knowledge and related vocabulary.

*Clarification 2:* See [Context Clues](#) and [Word Relationships](#).

*Clarification 3:* See [6.R.3.1](#) and [Secondary Figurative Language](#).

**Standard Relation to Course: Major**

- [ELA.K12.EE.1.1](#): Cite evidence to explain and justify reasoning.

**Clarifications:**

K-1 Students include textual evidence in their oral communication with guidance and support from adults. The evidence can consist of details from the text without naming the text. During 1st grade, students learn how to incorporate the evidence in their writing.

2-3 Students include relevant textual evidence in their written and oral communication. Students should name the text when they refer to it. In 3rd grade, students should use a combination of direct and indirect citations.

4-5 Students continue with previous skills and reference comments made by speakers and peers. Students cite texts that they've directly quoted, paraphrased, or used for information. When writing, students will use the form of citation dictated by the instructor or the style guide referenced by the instructor.

6-8 Students continue with previous skills and use a style guide to create a proper citation.

9-12 Students continue with previous skills and should be aware of existing style guides and the ways in which they differ.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELA.K12.EE.2.1](#): Read and comprehend grade-level complex texts proficiently.

**Clarifications:**

See [Text Complexity](#) for grade-level complexity bands and a text complexity rubric.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELA.K12.EE.3.1](#): Make inferences to support comprehension.

**Clarifications:**

Students will make inferences before the words infer or inference are introduced. Kindergarten students will answer questions like “Why is the girl smiling?” or make predictions about what will happen based on the title page. Students will use the terms and apply them in 2nd grade and beyond.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELA.K12.EE.4.1](#): Use appropriate collaborative techniques and active listening skills when engaging in discussions in a variety of situations.

**Clarifications:**

In kindergarten, students learn to listen to one another respectfully.

In grades 1-2, students build upon these skills by justifying what they are thinking. For example: “I think \_\_\_\_\_ because \_\_\_\_\_.” The collaborative conversations are becoming academic conversations.

In grades 3-12, students engage in academic conversations discussing claims and justifying their reasoning, refining and applying skills. Students build on ideas, propel the conversation, and support claims and counterclaims with evidence.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELA.K12.EE.5.1](#): Use the accepted rules governing a specific format to create quality work.

**Clarifications:**

Students will incorporate skills learned into work products to produce quality work. For students to incorporate these skills appropriately, they must receive instruction. A 3rd grade student creating a poster board display must have instruction in how to effectively present information to do quality work.



**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELA.K12.EE.6.1](#): Use appropriate voice and tone when speaking or writing.

**Clarifications:**

In kindergarten and 1st grade, students learn the difference between formal and informal language. For example, the way we talk to our friends differs from the way we speak to adults. In 2nd grade and beyond, students practice appropriate social and academic language to discuss texts.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELD.K12.ELL.LA.1](#): English language learners communicate information, ideas and concepts necessary for academic success in the content area of Language Arts.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

- [ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1](#): English language learners communicate for social and instructional purposes within the school setting.

**Standard Relation to Course: Supporting**

## Course Information

### General Notes

English Language Arts is not a discrete set of skills, but a rich discipline with meaningful, significant content, the knowledge of which helps all students actively and fully participate in our society.

Standards should not stand alone as a separate focus for instruction, but should be combined purposefully.

The texts students read should be meaningful and thought-provoking, preparing them to be informed, civic-minded members of their community.

Curricular content for all subjects must integrate critical-thinking, problem-solving, and workforce-literacy skills; communication, reading, and writing skills; mathematics skills; collaboration skills; contextual and applied-learning skills; technology-literacy skills; information and media-literacy skills; and civic-engagement skills.

### English Language Development ELD Standards Special Notes Section:

Teachers are required to provide listening, speaking, reading and writing instruction that allows English language learners (ELL) to communicate information, ideas and concepts for academic success in

the content area of Language Arts. For the given level of English language proficiency and with visual, graphic, or interactive support, students will interact with grade level words, expressions, sentences and discourse to process or produce language necessary for academic success. The ELD standard should specify a relevant content area concept or topic of study chosen by curriculum developers and teachers which maximizes an ELL's need for communication and social skills. To access an ELL supporting document which delineates performance definitions and descriptors, please click on the following link:

<https://cpalmsmediaproduct.blob.core.windows.net/uploads/docs/standards/eld/la.pdf>.

## Version Requirements

Approximately one-third of the titles from the [6th Grade Sample Book List](#) should be used in instruction.

## General Information

**Course Number:** 1001010

**Course Path:** **Section:** Grades PreK to 12 Education Courses >

**Grade Group:** Grades 6 to 8 Education Courses > **Subject:**

English/Language Arts > **SubSubject:** English >

**Abbreviated Title:** M/J LANG ARTS 1

**Course Length:** Year (Y)

**Course Attributes:**

- Class Size Core Required

**Course Type:** Core Academic Course

**Course Level:** 2

**Course Status:** State Board Approved

**Grade Level(s):** 6,7,8

## Educator Certifications

One of these educator certification options is required to teach this course.

- [Middle Grades Integrated Curriculum \(Middle Grades 5-9\)](#)
- [Middle Grades English \(Middle Grades 5-9\)](#)

- [English \(Grades 6-12\)](#)
- [English Speakers of Other Languages \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)
- [Elementary Education \(Grades K-6\)](#)
- [Elementary Education \(Elementary Grades 1-6\)](#)
- [Middle Grades Integrated Curriculum \(Middle Grades 5-9\) Plus English Speakers of Other Languages \(ESOL\) Endorsement](#)
- [Middle Grades English \(Middle Grades 5-9\) Plus English Speakers of Other Languages \(ESOL\) Endorsement](#)
- [English \(Grades 6-12\) Plus English Speakers of Other Languages \(ESOL\) Endorsement](#)
- [Elementary Education \(Elementary Grades 1-6\) Plus English Speakers of Other Languages \(ESOL\) Endorsement](#)
- [Elementary Education \(Grades K-6\) Plus English Speakers of Other Languages \(ESOL\) Endorsement](#)
- [English \(Elementary Grades 1-6\)](#)
- [Classical Education - Restricted \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)

Section 1012.55(5), F.S., authorizes the issuance of a classical education teaching certificate, upon the request of a classical school, to any applicant who fulfills the requirements of s. 1012.56(2)(a)-(f) and (11), F.S., and Rule 6A-4.004, F.A.C. Classical schools must meet the requirements outlined in s. 1012.55(5), F.S., and be listed in the [FLDOE Master School ID](#) database, to request a restricted classical education teaching certificate on behalf of an applicant.